

µFifa '26 - Submission Validation Guide

This document outlines the strict validation rules for your predictions CSV file. Ensure your submission complies with all rules before uploading.

1. File Format Requirements

- **Format:** The file must be a standard `.csv` file.
- **Max Size:** 5MB
- **Columns:** Your file must perfectly match the columns provided in the downloaded template.
- **Matches:** You must provide a prediction for every single match provided in the template. Do not add extra matches or omit any matches.

2. General Field Definitions

- **Predicted Winner:** Must be the exact team name as provided in the `home_team` or `away_team` columns, or "Draw".
- **Scores & Stats:**
 - `predicted_home_score` / `away_score`: Must be positive integers.
 - `predicted_possession_home` / `away`: Must sum to exactly 100.
 - `predicted_shots_home` / `away`: Must be positive integers.
 - `predicted_xg_home` / `away`: Decimals allowed.
 - `predicted_yellow_home` / `away`: Positive integers.
 - `predicted_red_home` / `away`: Positive integers.
- **Extra Time & Penalties:** Leave empty if not applicable. If predicting penalties, provide positive integers.

3. Confidence Score Rules

- The `confidence` column supports **BOTH** of the following formats:
 - **Probability format:** A value between 0 and 1 (e.g., 0.25, 0.5, 0.85, 1).
 - **Percentage format:** A value between 0 and 100 (e.g., 25, 50, 85, 100).

- The validator automatically interprets and normalizes either format.
- Values outside the `0-100` range or negative numbers will be rejected.

4. Goal Scorer Formats

- Multiple goal scorers are fully supported.
- You can separate multiple players using either a **comma (,)** or a **semicolon (;)**.
- Example of valid entries:
 - `Messi`
 - `Messi, Ronaldo`
 - `Messi; Ronaldo`
 - `Messi:2; Ronaldo:1` (optional goal-count syntax)
- Note: Goal-count syntax (`Name:Goals`) is optional but highly recommended. If omitted, the scoring engine may not award exact-goal-count bonus points.

5. Submission Deadline Rules

- All predictions are locked as soon as the first match of the Round of 32 kicks off.
- The platform enforces a strict deadline. Late submissions will be rejected by the server.
- You can overwrite your predictions up until the deadline by simply uploading a new CSV.

6. Pre-Submission Checklist

- ☐ Did you download the latest template from the platform?
- ☐ Is your `confidence` score between 0 and 100?
- ☐ Did you ensure possession sums strictly to 100?
- ☐ Have you provided exactly the number of match rows expected?
- ☐ Is your `tournament_champion` filled accurately?